



News Release

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8:30 A.M. (Eastern) Thursday, November 17, 2016

Notice: Since the usual Thursday release date for the U.S. Department of Labor's Unemployment Insurance Weekly Claims Report falls on Thanksgiving Day, which is a federal holiday, the report date has been moved to Wednesday, November 23, 2016.

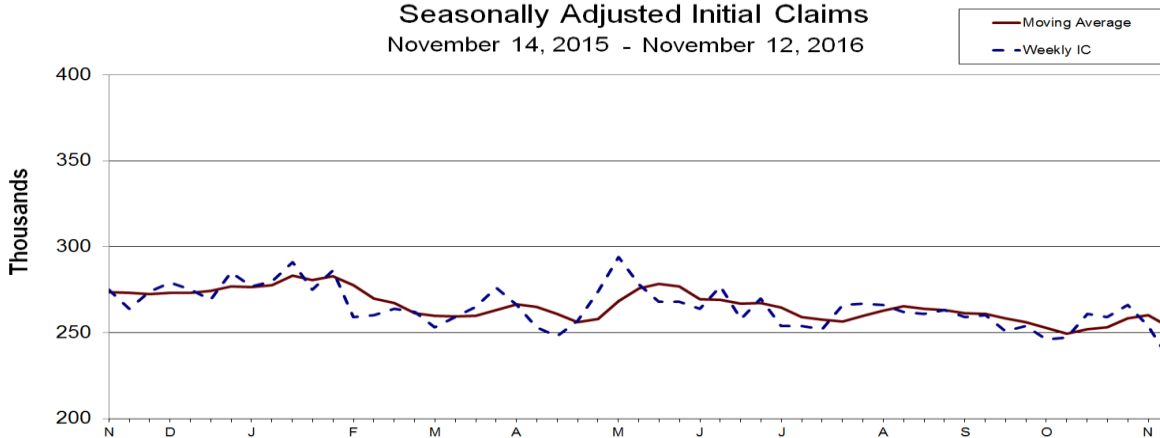
UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE WEEKLY CLAIMS SEASONALLY ADJUSTED DATA

In the week ending November 12, the advance figure for seasonally adjusted **initial claims** was 235,000, a decrease of 19,000 from the previous week's unrevised level of 254,000. This is the lowest level for initial claims since November 24, 1973 when it was 233,000. The 4-week moving average was 253,500, a decrease of 6,500 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised up by 250 from 259,750 to 260,000.

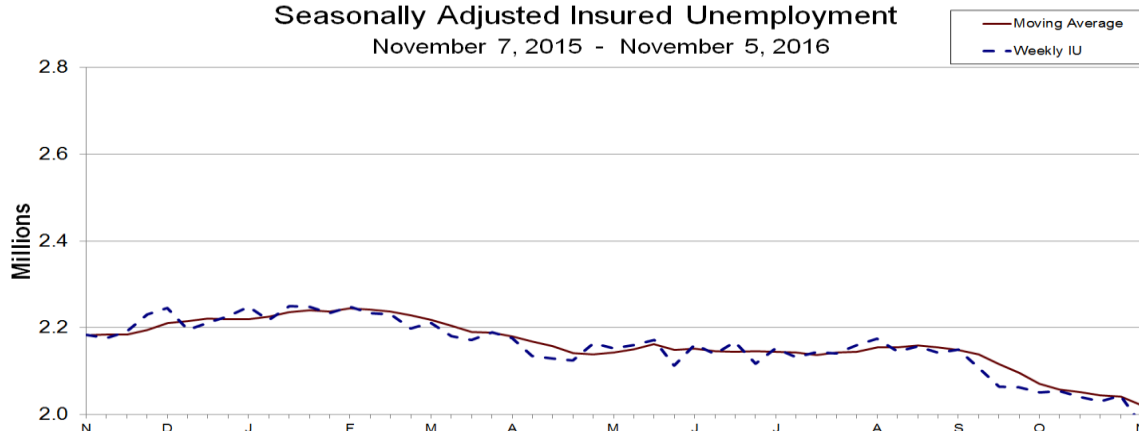
There were no special factors impacting this week's initial claims. This marks 89 consecutive weeks of initial claims below 300,000, the longest streak since 1970.

The advance seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment rate** was 1.4 percent for the week ending November 5, a decrease of 0.1 percentage point from the previous week's unrevised rate. The advance number for seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment** during the week ending November 5 was 1,977,000, a decrease of 66,000 from the previous week's revised level. This is the lowest level for insured unemployment since April 15, 2000 when it was 1,962,000. The previous week's level was revised up 2,000 from 2,041,000 to 2,043,000. The 4-week moving average was 2,022,500, a decrease of 19,250 from the previous week's revised average. This is the lowest level for this average since June 17, 2000 when it was 2,016,750. The previous week's average was revised up by 2,250 from 2,039,500 to 2,041,750.

Seasonally Adjusted Initial Claims
November 14, 2015 - November 12, 2016



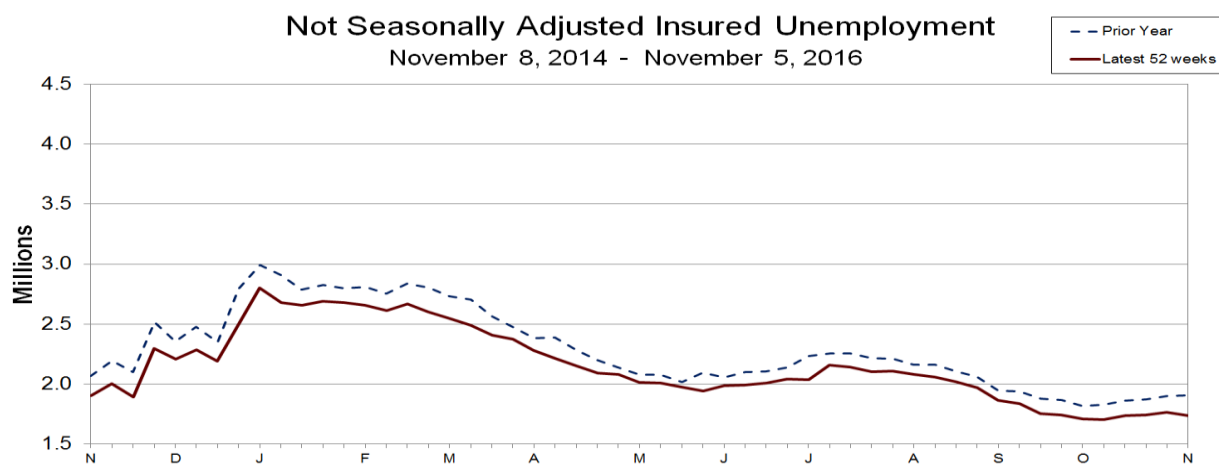
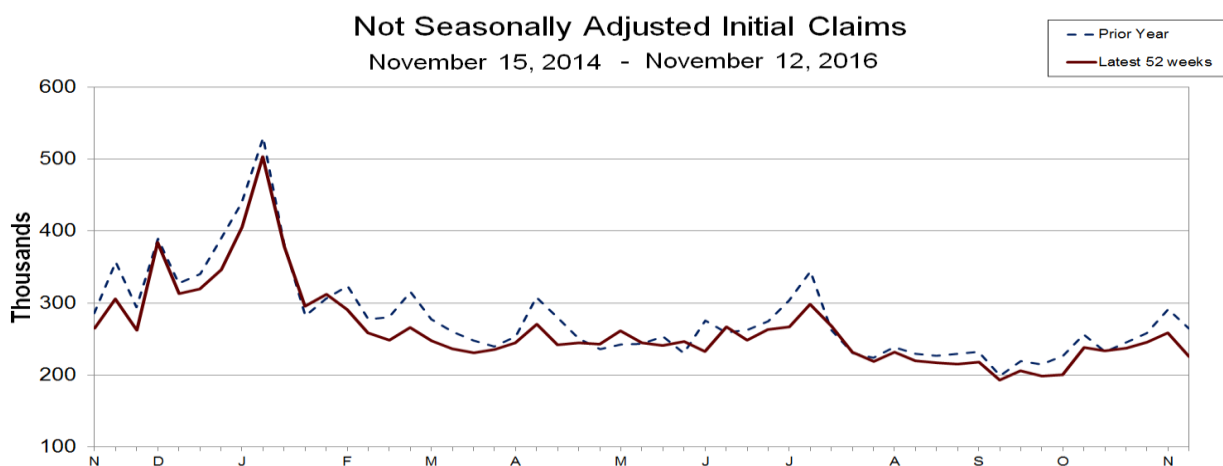
Seasonally Adjusted Insured Unemployment
November 7, 2015 - November 5, 2016



UNADJUSTED DATA

The advance number of actual initial claims under state programs, unadjusted, totaled 225,366 in the week ending November 12, a decrease of 33,234 (or -12.9 percent) from the previous week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 14,748 (or -5.7 percent) from the previous week. There were 264,816 initial claims in the comparable week in 2015.

The advance unadjusted insured unemployment rate was 1.3 percent during the week ending November 5, unchanged from the prior week. The advance unadjusted number for persons claiming UI benefits in state programs totaled 1,735,911, a decrease of 27,245 (or -1.5 percent) from the preceding week. The seasonal factors had expected an increase of 30,646 (or 1.7 percent) from the previous week. A year earlier the rate was 1.4 percent and the volume was 1,905,959.



The total number of people claiming benefits in all programs for the week ending October 29 was 1,806,847, an increase of 23,556 from the previous week. There were 1,950,866 persons claiming benefits in all programs in the comparable week in 2015.

No state was triggered "on" the Extended Benefits program during the week ending October 29.

Initial claims for UI benefits filed by former Federal civilian employees totaled 1,514 in the week ending November 5, an increase of 216 from the prior week. There were 1,077 initial claims filed by newly discharged veterans, an increase of 69 from the preceding week.

There were 13,400 former Federal civilian employees claiming UI benefits for the week ending October 29, an increase of 2,814 from the previous week. Newly discharged veterans claiming benefits totaled 13,438, an increase of 103 from the prior week.

The highest insured unemployment rates in the week ending October 29 were in Alaska (3.4), Puerto Rico (2.6), the Virgin Islands (2.4), New Jersey (2.2), California (2.0), Connecticut (2.0), Pennsylvania (1.9), Massachusetts (1.7), Nevada (1.7), West Virginia (1.7), and Wyoming (1.7).

The largest increases in initial claims for the week ending November 5 were in New York (+2,235), Texas (+2,166), Michigan (+2,016), Pennsylvania (+1,684), and Massachusetts (+1,526), while the largest decreases were in Kentucky (-4,452), Missouri (-4,186), North Carolina (-943), Georgia (-401), and the Virgin Islands (-23).

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE DATA FOR REGULAR STATE PROGRAMS

WEEK ENDING	November 12	November 5	Change	October 29	Prior Year ¹
Initial Claims (SA)	235,000	254,000	-19,000	266,000	275,000
Initial Claims (NSA)	225,366	258,600	-33,234	245,751	264,816
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	253,500	260,000	-6,500	258,250	273,500
WEEK ENDING	November 5	October 29	Change	October 22	Prior Year ¹
Insured Unemployment (SA)	1,977,000	2,043,000	-66,000	2,030,000	2,183,000
Insured Unemployment (NSA)	1,735,911	1,763,156	-27,245	1,741,962	1,905,959
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	2,022,500	2,041,750	-19,250	2,043,500	2,182,250
Insured Unemployment Rate (SA) ²	1.4%	1.5%	-0.1	1.5%	1.6%
Insured Unemployment Rate (NSA) ²	1.3%	1.3%	0.0	1.3%	1.4%

INITIAL CLAIMS FILED IN FEDERAL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	November 5	October 29	Change	Prior Year ¹
Federal Employees (UCFE)	1,514	1,298	+216	1,768
Newly Discharged Veterans (UCX)	1,077	1,008	+69	1,451

PERSONS CLAIMING UI BENEFITS IN ALL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	October 29	October 22	Change	Prior Year ¹
Regular State	1,757,442	1,737,007	+20,435	1,895,618
Federal Employees	13,400	10,586	+2,814	14,536
Newly Discharged Veterans	13,438	13,335	+103	17,272
Extended Benefits ³	0	0	0	0
State Additional Benefits ⁴	7,068	7,427	-359	7,256
STC / Workshare ⁵	15,499	14,936	+563	16,184
TOTAL	1,806,847	1,783,291	+23,556	1,950,866

FOOTNOTES

SA - Seasonally Adjusted Data, NSA - Not Seasonally Adjusted Data

1. Prior year is comparable to most recent data.
2. Most recent week used covered employment of 138,322,138 as denominator.
3. Information on the EB program can be found here: [EB Program information](#)
4. Some states maintain additional benefit programs for those claimants who exhaust regular, extended and emergency benefits. Information on states that participate, and the extent of benefits paid, can be found starting on page 4-5 of this link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)
5. Information on STC/Worksharing can be found starting on page 4-9 of the following link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)

Advance State Claims - Not Seasonally Adjusted

STATE	Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended November 12			Insured Unemployment For Week Ended November 5		
	Advance	Prior Wk	Change	Advance	Prior Wk	Change
Alabama	2,333	3,035	-702	18,409	19,295	-886
Alaska	2,007	1,854	153	10,577	10,606	-29
Arizona	3,185	4,184	-999	23,024	27,986	-4,962
Arkansas	1,571	2,234	-663	13,047	13,929	-882
California	39,846	47,345	-7,499	316,990	320,612	-3,622
Colorado	2,064	2,713	-649	23,570	24,788	-1,218
Connecticut	2,591	3,221	-630	33,578	32,989	589
Delaware	530	610	-80	4,998	5,355	-357
District of Columbia	516	443	73	7,645	8,157	-512
Florida	6,772	7,676	-904	38,285	43,843	-5,558
Georgia	4,938	6,109	-1,171	26,165	29,284	-3,119
Hawaii	960	1,239	-279	7,215	7,164	51
Idaho	1,230	1,679	-449	6,085	6,468	-383
Illinois	7,809	10,226	-2,417	91,146	91,283	-137
Indiana	2,984	3,061	-77	18,680	18,892	-212
Iowa	2,786	2,605	181	16,379	15,395	984
Kansas	1,847	2,144	-297	10,260	10,366	-106
Kentucky	2,971	3,341	-370	21,593	18,911	2,682
Louisiana	2,359	2,704	-345	23,276	23,516	-240
Maine	877	1,017	-140	4,764	4,515	249
Maryland	2,804	4,016	-1,212	29,578	32,992	-3,414
Massachusetts	5,917	6,891	-974	57,224	57,374	-150
Michigan	8,148	9,042	-894	41,631	42,092	-461
Minnesota	5,763	4,782	981	33,849	28,924	4,925
Mississippi	1,021	1,734	-713	8,996	10,790	-1,794
Missouri	1,905	3,763	-1,858	22,976	27,569	-4,593
Montana	1,254	1,437	-183	6,433	6,525	-92
Nebraska	792	829	-37	3,970	4,204	-234
Nevada	2,704	2,609	95	19,233	20,501	-1,268
New Hampshire	462	568	-106	3,439	3,792	-353
New Jersey	9,786	10,262	-476	85,431	86,037	-606
New Mexico	1,070	1,349	-279	11,000	11,219	-219
New York	17,540	17,170	370	134,240	130,024	4,216
North Carolina	4,094	4,695	-601	23,032	25,092	-2,060
North Dakota	933	566	367	3,811	2,438	1,373
Ohio	7,548	8,537	-989	49,934	48,447	1,487
Oklahoma	1,511	2,900	-1,389	19,348	19,107	241
Oregon	3,991	5,029	-1,038	25,568	25,865	-297
Pennsylvania	14,738	16,343	-1,605	103,313	104,084	-771
Puerto Rico	863	1,709	-846	20,944	23,085	-2,141
Rhode Island	1,028	1,035	-7	6,745	6,698	47
South Carolina	2,519	3,117	-598	13,953	14,753	-800
South Dakota	250	343	-93	1,313	1,245	68
Tennessee	2,353	2,853	-500	16,202	17,626	-1,424
Texas	15,821	17,998	-2,177	152,257	156,476	-4,219
Utah	1,506	1,528	-22	8,451	8,068	383
Vermont	531	733	-202	3,365	3,057	308
Virgin Islands	10	24	-14	542	894	-352
Virginia	3,008	3,037	-29	23,327	22,912	415
Washington	7,861	8,100	-239	46,001	44,105	1,896
West Virginia	850	1,240	-390	11,424	11,387	37
Wisconsin	5,979	6,267	-288	28,281	27,726	555
Wyoming	630	654	-24	4,414	4,694	-280
US Total	225,366	258,600	-33,234	1,735,911	1,763,156	-27,245

Note: Advance Claims are not directly comparable to claims reported in prior weeks. Advance claims are reported by the state liable for paying the unemployment compensation, whereas previous weeks reported reflect claimants by state of residence. In addition, claims reported as "workshare equivalent" in the previous week are added to the advance claims as a proxy for the current week's "workshare equivalent" activity.

Seasonally Adjusted US Weekly UI Claims (in thousands)

Week Ending	Initial Claims	Change from Prior Week	4-Week Average	Insured Unemployment	Change from Prior Week	4-Week Average	IUR
November 7, 2015	276	-2	271.00	2,183	-2	2,182.25	1.6
November 14, 2015	275	-1	273.50	2,176	-7	2,183.50	1.6
November 21, 2015	264	-11	273.25	2,191	15	2,183.75	1.6
November 28, 2015	274	10	272.25	2,230	39	2,195.00	1.6
December 5, 2015	279	5	273.00	2,245	15	2,210.50	1.7
December 12, 2015	275	-4	273.00	2,195	-50	2,215.25	1.6
December 19, 2015	269	-6	274.25	2,212	17	2,220.50	1.6
December 26, 2015	285	16	277.00	2,226	14	2,219.50	1.6
January 2, 2016	277	-8	276.50	2,248	22	2,220.25	1.6
January 9, 2016	280	3	277.75	2,217	-31	2,225.75	1.6
January 16, 2016	291	11	283.25	2,250	33	2,235.25	1.7
January 23, 2016	275	-16	280.75	2,248	-2	2,240.75	1.6
January 30, 2016	286	11	283.00	2,234	-14	2,237.25	1.6
February 6, 2016	259	-27	277.75	2,249	15	2,245.25	1.7
February 13, 2016	260	1	270.00	2,233	-16	2,241.00	1.6
February 20, 2016	264	4	267.25	2,231	-2	2,236.75	1.6
February 27, 2016	262	-2	261.25	2,198	-33	2,227.75	1.6
March 5, 2016	253	-9	259.75	2,212	14	2,218.50	1.6
March 12, 2016	259	6	259.50	2,180	-32	2,205.25	1.6
March 19, 2016	265	6	259.75	2,172	-8	2,190.50	1.6
March 26, 2016	276	11	263.25	2,189	17	2,188.25	1.6
April 2, 2016	266	-10	266.50	2,176	-13	2,179.25	1.6
April 9, 2016	253	-13	265.00	2,135	-41	2,168.00	1.6
April 16, 2016	248	-5	260.75	2,129	-6	2,157.25	1.6
April 23, 2016	257	9	256.00	2,124	-5	2,141.00	1.6
April 30, 2016	274	17	258.00	2,165	41	2,138.25	1.6
May 7, 2016	294	20	268.25	2,153	-12	2,142.75	1.6
May 14, 2016	278	-16	275.75	2,160	7	2,150.50	1.6
May 21, 2016	268	-10	278.50	2,172	12	2,162.50	1.6
May 28, 2016	268	0	277.00	2,112	-60	2,149.25	1.5
June 4, 2016	264	-4	269.50	2,162	50	2,151.50	1.6
June 11, 2016	277	13	269.25	2,139	-23	2,146.25	1.6
June 18, 2016	258	-19	266.75	2,167	28	2,145.00	1.6
June 25, 2016	270	12	267.25	2,117	-50	2,146.25	1.5
July 2, 2016	254	-16	264.75	2,153	36	2,144.00	1.6
July 9, 2016	254	0	259.00	2,132	-21	2,142.25	1.5
July 16, 2016	252	-2	257.50	2,144	12	2,136.50	1.6
July 23, 2016	266	14	256.50	2,141	-3	2,142.50	1.6
July 30, 2016	267	1	259.75	2,160	19	2,144.25	1.6
August 6, 2016	266	-1	262.75	2,175	15	2,155.00	1.6
August 13, 2016	262	-4	265.25	2,145	-30	2,155.25	1.6
August 20, 2016	261	-1	264.00	2,157	12	2,159.25	1.6
August 27, 2016	263	2	263.00	2,142	-15	2,154.75	1.6
September 3, 2016	259	-4	261.25	2,149	7	2,148.25	1.6
September 10, 2016	260	1	260.75	2,108	-41	2,139.00	1.5
September 17, 2016	251	-9	258.25	2,064	-44	2,115.75	1.5
September 24, 2016	254	3	256.00	2,062	-2	2,095.75	1.5
October 1, 2016	246	-8	252.75	2,050	-12	2,071.00	1.5
October 8, 2016	247	1	249.50	2,054	4	2,057.50	1.5
October 15, 2016	261	14	252.00	2,040	-14	2,051.50	1.5
October 22, 2016	259	-2	253.25	2,030	-10	2,043.50	1.5
October 29, 2016	266	7	258.25	2,043	13	2,041.75	1.5
November 5, 2016	254	-12	260.00	1,977	-66	2,022.50	1.4
November 12, 2016	235	-19	253.50				

Figures Appearing In columns showing Over-The-Week Changes reflect all revisions in data for prior week submitted by State agencies.

2. Rate is not seasonally adjusted. The source of US total covered employment is BLS.

UNADJUSTED INITIAL CLAIMS FOR WEEK ENDED NOVEMBER 5, 2016

STATES WITH AN INCREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
NY	+2,235	Layoffs in the manufacturing, construction, and information industries.
TX	+2,166	Layoffs in the manufacturing, construction, transportation and warehousing, retail trade, and health care and social assistance industries.
MI	+2,016	Layoffs in the wholesale trade industry.
PA	+1,684	Layoffs in the arts, entertainment, and recreation, and administrative, support, waste management and remediation service industries.
MA	+1,526	Layoffs in the administrative, support, waste management and remediation service, and arts, entertainment, and recreation industries.
NJ	+1,432	Layoffs in the construction, transportation and warehousing, and professional, scientific and technical service industries.
OK	+1,281	No comment.
IL	+1,254	Layoffs in the construction, manufacturing, and administrative, support, waste management and remediation service industries.
OH	+1,028	No comment.

STATES WITH A DECREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000

State	Change	State Supplied Comment
KY	-4,452	No comment.
MO	-4,186	Fewer layoffs in the construction, manufacturing, and retail trade industry.

TECHNICAL NOTES

This news release presents the weekly unemployment insurance (UI) claims reported by each state's unemployment insurance program offices. These claims may be used for monitoring workload volume, assessing state program operations and for assessing labor market conditions. States initially report claims directly taken by the state liable for the benefit payments, regardless of where the claimant who filed the claim resided. These are the basis for the advance initial claims and continued claims reported each week. These data come from ETA 538, Advance Weekly Initial and Continued Claims Report. The following week initial claims and continued claims are revised based on a second reporting by states that reflect the claimants by state of residence. These data come from the ETA 539, Weekly Claims and Extended Benefits Trigger Data Report.

A. Initial Claims

An initial claim is a claim filed by an unemployed individual after a separation from an employer. The claimant requests a determination of basic eligibility for the UI program. When an initial claim is filed with a state, certain programmatic activities take place and these result in activity counts including the count of initial claims. The count of U.S. initial claims for unemployment insurance is a leading economic indicator because it is an indication of emerging labor market conditions in the country. However, these are weekly administrative data which are difficult to seasonally adjust, making the series subject to some volatility.

B. Continued Weeks Claimed

A person who has already filed an initial claim and who has experienced a week of unemployment then files a continued claim to claim benefits for that week of unemployment. Continued claims are also referred to as insured unemployment. The count of U.S. continued weeks claimed is also a good indicator of labor market conditions. Continued claims reflect the current number of insured unemployed workers filing for UI benefits in the nation. While continued claims are not a leading indicator (they roughly coincide with economic cycles at their peaks and lag at cycle troughs), they provide confirming evidence of the direction of the U.S. economy.

C. Seasonal Adjustments and Annual Revisions

Over the course of a year, the weekly changes in the levels of initial claims and continued claims undergo regularly occurring fluctuations. These fluctuations may result from seasonal changes in weather, major holidays, the opening and closing of schools, or other similar events. Because these seasonal events follow a more or less regular pattern each year, their influence on the level of a series can be tempered by adjusting for regular seasonal variation. These adjustments make trend and cycle developments easier to spot. At the beginning of each calendar year, the Bureau of Labor Statistics provides the Employment and Training Administration (ETA) with a set of seasonal factors to apply to the unadjusted data during that year. Concurrent with the implementation and release of the new seasonal factors, ETA incorporates revisions to the UI claims historical series caused by updates to the unadjusted data.

[Weekly Claims Archives](#)

[Weekly Claims Data](#)

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